

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a three-part setting (Soprano, Alto, and Bass) in 3/4 time, with a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The score is divided into four systems, each with a treble and bass staff. The lyrics are written below the staves, with line numbers 1, 2, and 3 indicating different parts of the text. Chord symbols are placed above the staves to indicate the harmonic structure.

System 1: Chords: E $\flat$, Fm, B $\flat$, E $\flat$.
Lyrics: 1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom

System 2: Chords: E $\flat$, A $\flat$, B $\flat$ sus, B $\flat$, E $\flat$.
Lyrics: hung with bloom a - long the bough,
twen - ty will not come a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

System 3: Chords: A $\flat$, Fm, G.
Lyrics: it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

System 4: Chords: E $\flat$ /G, Gm, Fm, B $\flat$, E $\flat$.
Lyrics: wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.